the

BURNOUT RESET

A 7-DAY RECOVERY PLAN FOR WOMEN WHO ARE TIRED OF BEING TIRED

a guide from

DOLLY BUILDS

Welcome

You're not lazy.
You're running on empty.

If you picked up this guide, chances are you already know the feeling. You wake up tired. You get through the day on autopilot. You're doing everything — the job, the home, the family, the being-fine — and somewhere along the way, you stopped feeling like yourself.

You don't need another lecture about self-care Sundays or bubble baths. You need a practical way to get your energy, clarity, and self back — without quitting your job tomorrow, and without adding one more overwhelming thing to your plate.

That's what this is. Seven days. Ten to twenty minutes a day. One small, doable shift at a time.

> *"You can't pour from an empty cup —*
> *but you can stop pretending the cup is full."*

How to use this guide: each day has a short read and a worksheet. Do them in order — the days build on each other. You can start any day of the week, but mornings or just before bed work best. Keep a pen nearby; writing by hand slows the mind down in the best way.

By Day 7, you won't be "fixed" — burnout doesn't work like that. But you will have named what's draining you, plugged your biggest leaks, rested without guilt at least once, and designed a week you can actually live with. That's a real beginning.

BEFORE WE BEGIN

Is This Burnout?

check every box that feels familiar

- ◯ I wake up tired, even after a full night's sleep.
- ◯ I start dreading Monday on Saturday evening.
- ◯ Small tasks — replying to a message, booking an appointment — feel weirdly heavy.
- ◯ I'm more cynical, irritable, or snappy than I used to be.
- ◯ My mind won't shut up at night, but goes blank when I need to focus.
- ◯ I keep saying "after this deadline, things will calm down" — and they never do.
- ◯ Things I used to enjoy now feel like obligations.
- ◯ I feel guilty when I rest, so I rest badly — scrolling, half-working, half-worrying.
- ◯ I've stopped feeling proud of my work, even when I do it well.
- ◯ I fantasize about disappearing for a while — no calls, no questions, no one needing me.

WHAT YOUR SCORE MEANS

0–3: you're stretched, not burnt out — this guide will help you protect your energy before it slides. **4–7:** you're in the burnout zone; the next seven days matter. **8–10:** you've been running on empty for a while. Be gentle with yourself this week — and if heaviness or hopelessness persists, please also talk to a doctor or therapist. This guide supports you; it doesn't replace professional care.

YOUR WEEK AHEAD

The 7 Days at a Glance

small steps, in order, on purpose

Day 1	**Name What's Draining You** Stop calling it "just tired." See your burnout clearly, on paper.
Day 2	**Quiet the Noise** Empty the racing mind with a guided brain dump.
Day 3	**Plug the Energy Leaks** Find where your energy actually goes — and set one boundary.
Day 4	**Rest Without Guilt** Learn the type of rest you're starved of, and take it — on purpose.
Day 5	**Come Back to Your Body** Sleep, movement, and micro-breaks: the physical side of recovery.
Day 6	**Remember Who You Are** Reconnect with the person you were before you were this tired.
Day 7	**Design Your Comeback** Build a week you can live with — and make your next move calmly.

THE RULES OF THE RESET

1. Ten to twenty minutes a day. More is not better. 2. Write by hand if you can. 3. Done, not perfect — a messy worksheet beats a skipped one. 4. You don't have to make any big decisions this week. You just have to show up for yourself, seven times.

DAY ONE

Name What's Draining You

you can't fix what you won't name

Burnout hides behind polite words. "I'm just tired." "It's a busy phase." "Everyone's stressed." As long as it stays vague, it stays in charge. Today, we make it specific.

Burnout has three faces, and you might recognize all of them: **exhaustion** (your energy is gone before the day starts), **cynicism** (you've started caring less, on purpose, just to cope), and **a shrinking sense of yourself** (you do good work and feel nothing; you can't remember the last time you felt proud, or playful, or fully there).

Here's what matters: burnout is not a character flaw. It's the predictable result of prolonged output without recovery — made worse when you're carrying invisible loads too: being available to everyone, managing the home in the background, being the one who never drops a ball.

"Naming it isn't complaining.
Naming it is the first act of taking your life back."

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES

Complete the Day 1 worksheet honestly — no editing yourself, no "it's not that bad." Nobody sees this but you. Precision today makes every other day of this reset easier.

Day 1: The Burnout Audit

• What does a normal week look like for me right now — honestly?

• Which moments of the day drain me the most?

• What am I most tired of pretending to be fine about?

• If I could hand one responsibility to someone else this week, it would be...

• My energy today, from 1 (empty) to 10 (full): _____ I'll re-check this on Day 7.

DAY TWO

Quiet the Noise

for minds that won't shut up

Burnout isn't only about doing too much. It's about *carrying* too much — the replaying of conversations, the mental to-do lists, the 2 a.m. spiral about that one email. Your mind is running background apps all day, and they're draining the battery.

The fastest relief is embarrassingly simple: get it out of your head and onto paper. Psychologists call it "cognitive offloading." I call it a brain dump. When a thought is written down, your brain stops treating it as an open loop it must keep alive — and quietly lets it go.

The rule: write fast, messy, and without judgment. Half sentences are fine. Petty things are fine. "I'm angry that nobody notices how much I do" is more than fine — that one usually needs to come out first.

> *"Your mind is for having ideas,*
> *not for holding them."*

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES

Set a timer for 7 minutes and fill the brain-dump box on the next page with everything on your mind. Then take 3 minutes for the sorting step below it. That's it. Notice how much lighter your head feels — this is a tool you can use any day, forever.

Day 2: The Brain Dump

• Empty your mind here — everything, in any order, no editing (7 minutes):

• Circle the three things above that are actually mine to solve this week.

• One small action I can take on one of them tomorrow:

_____

_____

• One thing I've been carrying that I'm officially putting down (not my problem, not this week, or not in my control):

_____

_____

DAY THREE

Plug the Energy Leaks

boundaries are maintenance, not drama

Yesterday you emptied your mind. Today we find out where your energy actually goes — because burnout is rarely one big thing. It's a hundred small leaks: notifications you answer instantly, meetings that could have been messages, being everyone's default helper, saying yes before you've even checked with yourself.

Setting a boundary sounds confrontational, especially if you were raised to be agreeable, helpful, and endlessly available. So let's reframe it: a boundary is not a wall against people. It's a container for your energy. The people who respect you will adjust in a week. The discomfort you feel saying no lasts thirty seconds. The resentment from always saying yes lasts years.

> *"Every time you say yes to something that drains you, you say no to something that could restore you."*

BORROW THESE SCRIPTS

At work: "I can take this on, but something else on my plate will need to move — which should it be?" **The soft no:** "I won't be able to do this justice right now, so I'll pass." **The delay:** "Let me check my week and get back to you tomorrow." (Buying time is a boundary too.)

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES

List your leaks on the worksheet, pick the one that costs you the most, and choose one boundary to hold this week. One. Small and kept beats big and abandoned.

Day 3: The Energy Leak List

• My top five energy leaks (people, habits, tasks, apps — be specific):

• The one leak that costs me the most every week:

• The one boundary I will hold this week (what, with whom, starting when):

• What I'm afraid will happen if I say no — and what will most likely actually happen:

DAY FOUR

Rest Without Guilt

rest is a skill, and you can relearn it

Here's the trap most exhausted women fall into: you finally get a free evening, you spend it scrolling with mild guilt, and you wake up just as tired. That's because collapsing is not resting — and because not all tiredness needs the same cure.

There are different kinds of rest, and you're probably starved of a specific one: **physical** (sleep, stillness), **mental** (a break from decisions and problem-solving), **sensory** (silence, no screens), **emotional** (time where you don't have to manage anyone's feelings, including performing "I'm fine"), **social** (either genuine alone time, or time with people who don't drain you), and **creative** (beauty and play with no productive purpose).

And the guilt? Guilt shows up because somewhere along the way you learned that your worth is your output. It isn't. Rest is not a reward you earn after the to-do list is done — the list is never done. Rest is maintenance for a human being.

"You are allowed to rest
before you are exhausted."

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES (PLUS THIRTY)

Identify your most-starved type of rest on the worksheet, then schedule thirty minutes of it in the next 24 hours — phone in another room. Sign the permission slip. It sounds silly. Do it anyway; it works.

Day 4: Real Rest

• The type of rest I'm most starved of right now (physical / mental / sensory / emotional / social / creative):

_____

_____

• What real rest looks like for me — three things that genuinely refill me (not just numb me):

_____

_____

_____

• My thirty minutes of rest: what I'll do, and when exactly I'll take it in the next 24 hours:

_____

_____

• The story I tell myself when I feel guilty resting — and what I'd say to my best friend if she said it:

_____

_____

_____

• Permission slip: I, _____ , give myself full permission to rest without earning it first. Signed: _____



DAY FIVE

Come Back to Your Body

burnout lives in the body, not just the calendar

You can't think your way out of burnout, because burnout isn't only in your thoughts — it's in your shoulders that live near your ears, your jaw that's always slightly clenched, your shallow breath, your 1 a.m. scrolling that steals tomorrow's energy.

Today is about three small physical anchors, not a fitness overhaul:

1. Protect the wind-down. The hour before sleep decides the quality of your night. Screens off (or at least out of bed), lights low, and let your brain land — this is a perfect time for a two-minute brain dump if your mind starts racing.

2. Take micro-breaks. Every 90 minutes or so, stand up, roll your shoulders, look out a window, breathe. Sixty seconds. Attach it to something that already happens — after every meeting, before every chai — so you don't need willpower to remember.

3. Learn one grounding tool. When stress spikes, try a slow exhale: breathe in for four counts, out for eight, five times. A longer exhale signals your nervous system that the emergency is over. It's free, invisible, and works in the middle of a meeting.

"Your body keeps the score of every deadline.
Today, it gets a say."

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES

Fill the worksheet, then actually do one micro-break and one round of 4-in / 8-out breathing today. Notice the difference — that's your nervous system saying thank you.

Day 5: Body Check

• Where does stress show up in my body? (shoulders, jaw, stomach, sleep, headaches…)

• My sleep lately, honestly — what time I sleep, what steals it, how I wake up:

• My micro-break anchor: after _____ , I will pause for one minute and breathe.

• Tonight's wind-down: what I'll do in the last hour before bed (and where my phone will be):

• One kind thing my body has done for me this week, even while exhausted:

DAY SIX

Remember Who You Are

you existed before this job, this role, this tiredness

Somewhere between the deadlines and the responsibilities, a quiet thing happens: you become your roles. The employee. The daughter. The wife. The reliable one. And the person underneath — the one who laughed easily, had hobbies for no reason, and wanted things just because she wanted them — goes quiet.

Burnout recovery isn't complete when the exhaustion fades. It's complete when *you* come back. So today is not about work at all. It's about remembering what you're recovering *for*.

Think about the last time you lost track of time in a good way. The things you loved at fifteen, at twenty. What you'd do with a free Saturday if nobody needed anything from you and nobody was watching. These aren't luxuries or childish things. They're your identity — and identity is fuel.

"You are not the tired version of yourself.
That's just the version that's been on duty too long."

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES

Fill the worksheet, then pick ONE thing from your joy list and put it in your calendar for this week — even a twenty-minute version. Treat it like a meeting you can't cancel, because the person you're meeting is you.

Day 6: The Joy List

• Things I loved doing before I was this tired (go back years if you need to):

• The last time I felt fully like myself — where was I, who was I with, what was I doing?

• Three things that matter to me more than being impressive (my real values):

• The one joy-list item I'm scheduling this week — and when:

DAY SEVEN

Design Your Comeback

decide from clarity, not from exhaustion

You've named what drains you, emptied your mind, set a boundary, rested on purpose, listened to your body, and remembered who you are. Today, you turn all of it into a week you can actually live — and you look at the bigger question calmly.

First, your non-negotiables. Choose three small daily anchors you'll protect no matter how busy the week gets — a real lunch break, a wind-down hour, a two-minute brain dump. Non-negotiables are the difference between recovering and relapsing.

Then, the big question. Maybe you've been wondering whether to quit. Here's the honest truth: some burnout is about how you're working, and some is about where you're working. Day 1's audit usually tells you which. But make that call from a rested, clear mind — not a desperate one. "Stay and adjust," "stay while I build my exit," and "go" are all valid answers. Panic isn't a plan; clarity is.

"The goal was never just to feel better.
The goal is a life that doesn't require
recovering from itself."

TODAY'S TEN MINUTES

Complete the final worksheet, then re-score your energy (remember Day 1?). Most women find it's moved — not because life changed in a week, but because they stopped leaking and started choosing.

Day 7: My Comeback Plan

• My three daily non-negotiables (small, specific, protected):

_____

_____

_____

• This week I will STOP: / START: / KEEP:

_____

_____

_____

• About my work, my calm answer for now is (stay & adjust / stay & build my exit / go), because:

_____

_____

_____

• A note to the woman who started this guide seven days ago:

_____

_____

_____

• My energy today, 1–10: _____ (Day 1 it was: _____)



AFTER THE SEVEN DAYS

Your Early-Warning System

so you never slide this far again

Burnout doesn't arrive overnight, and it doesn't announce itself. It creeps. The skill that protects you now is noticing early. These are the most common early signals — learn yours:

- ◯ Skipping your non-negotiables "just this week."
- ◯ Sleep shrinking while screen time grows.
- ◯ Snapping at people you love over small things.
- ◯ Saying yes fast again — and feeling that old flicker of resentment.
- ◯ The Sunday-evening dread returning.

THE 10-MINUTE MAINTENANCE RITUAL

Daily (2 min): quick brain dump before bed — empty the loops. Weekly (5 min): energy score out of 10, plus one question: "what drained me most this week, and what's my boundary for next week?" Monthly (3 min): re-read your Day 7 comeback plan and adjust it. If your energy score stays below 4 for three weeks straight, treat it as a red light — revisit this guide, and consider talking to a professional.



KEEP GOING

This Was Your Reset. Here's How You Stay Reset.

two tools I made for exactly this

Seven days got you out of survival mode. Staying out of it is a daily practice — and these two companions were built to carry what you started here:

FOR THE RACING MIND · NOTION TEMPLATE

The WHY Method

The 10-minute brain declutter for women whose minds won't shut up. If Day 2 was your favorite day of this reset, this is that practice — deepened into a guided system you'll actually use daily. It helps you get every loop out of your head, question it, and end each day with a quiet mind.

FOR THE DAILY PRACTICE · PRINTABLE JOURNAL

The Self Reflection Journal

A guided journal built on Stoic wisdom — morning reflections, reframing stressful thoughts, dismantling limiting beliefs, and weekly and monthly check-ins. If Days 6 and 7 lit something up in you, this journal is how you keep meeting yourself on paper, long after this week ends.

FIND BOTH ON MY PAGE

Instagram: **@dollybuilds** — link in bio, or just DM me the word **RESET** and I'll send you the details.

a note from me

I made this guide because I've been the woman who was "fine." The one with the good job, the full calendar, and the empty tank. Nobody teaches us that exhaustion isn't a personality trait — I had to learn it the slow way, and I built this so you could learn it in seven days instead.

If this guide helped you, tell me. Send me a message, share your Day 7 energy score, tell me which day cracked something open. I read everything.

You were never lazy. You were never weak. You were just tired — and now you know what to do about it.

Dolly

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This guide is for education and self-reflection. It is not medical or psychological treatment, and it is not a substitute for professional care.
If you are experiencing persistent hopelessness or thoughts of self-harm, please reach out to a mental-health professional.
In India, you can call Tele-MANAS, the national mental-health helpline: 14416 (available 24/7).

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